YUPENG LIU

Leeds School of Business, University of Colorado Boulder
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RESEARCH INTERESTS

I am a PhD student at the University of Colorado Boulder studying user innovation and innovation management across innovation and entrepreneurial ecosystems. My research examines how firms use open-source governance to mobilize innovation from internal and external contributors and to democratize participation in innovation. I also study how place, institutions, and local conditions shape the formation and growth of new ventures. I use firm, platform, and GitHub data with computational and quasi-experimental methods.

EDUCATION

University of Colorado Boulder, Leeds School of Business — Boulder, CO
Ph.D. in Strategy and Entrepreneurship (expected 2030) — 08/2025 – Present

Georgetown University — Washington, DC
M.A. in Applied Economics — 08/2017 – 08/2018

University of Birmingham — Birmingham, United Kingdom
B.Sc. in Mathematics with Honors — 09/2014 – 06/2017
First Class Degree; ranked 2nd in a cohort of 200+

Huazhong University of Science and Technology — Wuhan, China
B.A. in Management (International Business) — 09/2012 – 06/2017
GPA: 3.8/4.0

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Andrews, Raymond J., Catherine Fazio, Jorge Guzman, **Yupeng Liu**, and Scott Stern (2022)[1]. "The Startup Cartography Project: Measuring and mapping entrepreneurial ecosystems." *Research Policy*, 51(2), 104437.

WORKING PAPERS

Liu, Yupeng, Tony W. Tong, and Yuping Li. "Dependence Reconfiguration: Open-Source Governance as a Response to Geopolitical Restrictions on Critical Technologies."

Tong, Tony W., **Yupeng Liu**, and Shihao Zhou. "The Rise of National AI Ecosystems: Geopolitical Competition and the State as Ecosystem Orchestrator."

Fazio, Catherine, Jorge Guzman, **Yupeng Liu**, and Scott Stern (2021). "How is COVID Changing the Geography of Entrepreneurship? Evidence from the Startup Cartography Project." NBER Working Paper #28787.

Guzman, Jorge, and **Yupeng Liu** (2019). "Do Entrepreneurs Respond to Everyday Changes in Financing Costs?"

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

"Construct Explorer: Infrastructure for Tracing Measurement Practice in Strategy Research."

"AI Review Summaries and the Allocation of Owner Attention: Evidence from Google Maps." With Jay Park and Shaoqin Tang. Panel of 13,700+ restaurants and 13.7M reviews across seven metropolitan areas, 2022–2026.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Strategic Management Society Annual Conference, Berlin, Germany — October 2026
Academy of Management Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA — August 2026
Open and User Innovation Conference, Harvard Business School, Boston, MA — July 2026
Strategy Science Conference, Leeds School of Business, University of Colorado Boulder — May 2026
Eastern Economic Association Annual Conference, Boston, MA — February 2020

[1] All authors contributed equally; author names are listed alphabetically.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Ad hoc reviewer: *Management and Organization Review*.

Strategy Science Conference 2026: built the conference website (strategyscience2026.org) on GitHub and Cloudflare Pages and administered the Firebase-based paper review system.

ACKNOWLEDGED RESEARCH ASSISTANTSHIPS

Bryan, Kevin, and Jorge Guzman (2023). "Entrepreneurial Migration." *Review of Economics and Statistics*.

Guzman, Jorge (2023). "The Direct Effect of Corporate Law on Entrepreneurship." *The Journal of Law, Economics, and Organization*, ewad024.

Fazio, Catherine, Jorge Guzman, and Scott Stern (2020). "The Impact of State-Level R&D Tax Credits on the Quantity and Quality of Entrepreneurship." *Economic Development Quarterly*, 34(2), 188–208.

Guzman, Jorge, and Scott Stern (2020). "The State of American Entrepreneurship: New Estimates of the Quantity and Quality of Entrepreneurship for 32 US States, 1988–2014." *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy*, 12(4), 212–243.

Catalini, Christian, Jorge Guzman, and Scott Stern (2019). "Passive Versus Active Growth: Evidence from Founder Choices and Venture Capital Investment." NBER Working Paper #26073.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Ernst & Young (EY) Singapore

Senior Associate, Digital Forensic Specialist 02/2023 – 06/2025

- Developed and deployed rule-based and predictive models in Python and SQL to identify suspicious transactions, focusing on procurement fraud and travel-and-entertainment expenses across transportation, retail, and energy.
- Automated DeFi transaction monitoring in Python, tracking balances and suspicious flows across Ethereum, Bitcoin, and Terra to uncover fraud at a crypto-lending firm tied to the 2022 Terra Luna collapse.
- Applied NLP to chat histories and OCR to graphical documents, converting unstructured records into structured evidence for investigations.
- Tested a major port authority's sanctions screening system using manipulated OFAC party lists to evaluate its fuzzy matching algorithm.
- Presented findings in Power BI and Tableau dashboards, translating investigation reports into evidence supporting or refuting custodial claims.

Columbia Business School New York, NY

Full-Time Research Associate, The Startup Cartography Project 10/2018 – 06/2020

- Acquired, parsed, and cleaned 44 million business registration records from 50 U.S. Secretary of State offices, merging them with USPTO patent and trademark histories and SDC Platinum M&A data to estimate firm growth indicators.
- Built logit and random-forest models to estimate entrepreneurial quality indices; published and maintained state-, county-, and ZIP-level datasets for public use, and geocoded firm addresses for interactive maps.
- Worked with the Kentucky Secretary of State's office on regional entrepreneurship analysis and visualization for state officials.
- Developed quality-adjusted distance measures for research on firm agglomeration.

SKILLS

Methods: Difference-in-differences and staggered DID (Callaway–Sant'Anna), panel causal inference, quasi-experimental design, machine learning for prediction, text analysis and neural embeddings.

Data: Large-scale GitHub and Hugging Face panels, web-scale collection and parsing, business registration and administrative records, USPTO patents and trademarks, Common Crawl, job postings.

Software: Python, Stata, R, SQL, Git, Power BI, Tableau.

Languages: Chinese (native), English (fluent), French (beginner).